CASCADIA ANALYTICS

INVESTMENT SCORECARD

MRNA

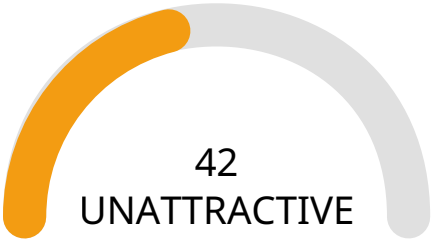
Moderna, Inc. (NASDAQ)

As-of: 23-Oct-2026 | Latest Filing: Q2 2026 (10-Q) | Currency: USD

$198.66 [Mkt 23-Oct-26]

Market Cap: $71.4B [Mkt 23-Oct-26]

Attractiveness Score



Confidence: **Medium** (0 pillars excluded)

Pillar Breakdown

1. Operating Quality — 55

Genuine mRNA platform moat with only BioNTech as a real peer, and $6.9B in cash and investments. But there is no recurring revenue engine: margins are -141%, ROIC deeply negative, and the business still burns billions a year.

2. Recent Trend — 40

Revenue collapsed three years straight: -64%, -53%, -40%. Q2 2026 stabilized at +2% but off a $145M quarterly base. The real trend is cost discipline: opex cut $2.2B (30%) in 2025. Losses are narrowing, not because the business is growing.

3. Forward Growth — 55

Credible but binary drivers: FDA-approved flu vaccine, mNEXSPIKE rollout, EU respiratory market opening 2027, Intismeran melanoma readout. Consensus only projects $3.39B revenue by 2028, 75% above 2025 but under half of 2023.

4. Valuation — 25

At $198.66, market pays 44x trailing sales and 24x consensus 2028 revenue. Our DCF base is $93.75 (53% downside) and even the bull case $187.57 sits below the price. Reverse DCF implies 117.5% CAGR, pure perfection pricing. Consensus target $101 is -58% away.

5. Catalysts & Risk — 40

Real near-term catalysts: Intismeran Oct 24 presentation, Q3 earnings Nov 5, flu launch. But risk skew is sharply negative

at a 52-week high after a 306% six-month run. $950M Arbutus payment, $2.6B convert dilution, and FDA refusal-to-file history add overhang.

Investment Thesis

- **Platform Rich, Business Poor:** Real mRNA moat, $6.9B in cash and investments [10-Q Q2 26], flu vaccine approved. But revenue fell from $19.3B (2022) to $1.94B (2025) [8-K FY25], and the business still loses ~$3B a year.
- **Binary Oncology Option:** Intismeran Phase III melanoma data on Oct 24, 2026 is the swing factor. The 306% six-month run has priced in success; a miss unwinds fast toward the $101 consensus target [Cons].
- **Price Denies the DCF:** At $198.66 [Mkt 17-Oct-26], the market implies 117.5% revenue CAGR. Our base case $93.75 means -53% downside, and the bull case $187.57 does not even reach the current price.

Key Operating Metrics

Metric	Latest	YoY Change	3Y Trend
Revenue (FY2025)	$1.94B [8-K FY25]	-39.9% [8-K FY25]	Down
Revenue (Q2 2026)	$145M [10-Q Q2 26]	+2.1% [10-Q Q2 26]	Flat
Net Loss (FY2025)	-$2.82B [8-K FY25]	-$7.26/sh [8-K FY25]	Down
Cash & Investments (Jun 30, 2026)	$6.9B [10-Q Q2 26]	$4.7-5.2B guide yr-end [8-K guid]	Down
2026 Revenue Guide	up to +10% [8-K guid]	off $1.94B base [8-K guid]	Up
2028 Revenue Consensus	$3.39B [Cons]	+75% vs 2025 [Cons]	Up

Historical Financial Trend

Metric	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25	TTM
Revenue	$19.26B [Cons]	$6.85B [Cons]	$3.24B [Cons]	$1.94B [8-K FY25]	$2.23B [Cons]
Net Loss	n/a [n/a]	n/a [n/a]	n/a [n/a]	-$2.82B [8-K FY25]	-$3.20B [Cons]
Cash & Investments	n/a [n/a]	n/a [n/a]	n/a [n/a]	$8.1B [8-K FY25]	$6.9B [10-Q Q2 26]

Valuation

Absolute (2/10)

P/S (trailing) 44x [Mkt 17-Oct-26]
P/B 9.7x [Mkt 17-Oct-26]
DCF Base $93.75, -53% downside [DCF]

The market prices 24x consensus 2028 revenue for a business still losing billions. Our DCF says the price is not even supported by the bull case ($187.57).

Versus Peers (3/8)

BNTX, NVAX surged too [Mkt 17-Oct-26]
Consensus target $101, Hold [Cons]

MRNA trades at the richest multiple among vaccine biotechs while 26 analysts rate it a Hold with targets 58% below the price.

Versus History (2/7)

$198.66 vs $22 Nov 2025 low [Mkt 17-Oct-26]
10x rally on no revenue growth

The entire move is multiple expansion on pipeline hope, not financials. Prior peaks collapsed 90%+.

Catalyst Timeline

24-Oct-2026 [8-K guid]
Intismeran Melanoma Data (Positive): Phase III interim readout with Merck; the single biggest swing factor for the pipeline premium.

05-Nov-2026 [Cons]
Q3 2026 Earnings (Two-Sided): Consensus -$1.10 EPS; U.S. vaccination rate and fall rollout color will matter more than the print.

Top Risk Factors (Item 1A)

1. COVID Revenue Collapse: COVID revenue is in secular decline while the pipeline is years from meaningful revenue. Q2 product sales fell 18% YoY; U.S. vaccination rates are the key variable management cannot control. [10-Q Q2 26]

2. Regulatory Risk: The FDA issued a refusal-to-file letter for the mRNA-1010 flu application on trial-design grounds despite prior protocol discussions.

2026 [8-K guid]
Flu Vaccine Launch (Positive): mRNA-1010 FDA approved Sep 2026; first commercial season diversifies beyond COVID.

2026 [8-K guid]
Norovirus Phase III Readout (Two-Sided): Earlier interim missed early statistical criteria; additional cohort enrolled.

What Would Change Our Score

The Oct 24, 2026 Intismeran melanoma readout is the swing factor. A clean positive validates the oncology pipeline and the platform premium; a miss or statistical ambiguity unwinds the 306% rally toward the $101 consensus target and our $93.75 DCF base.

Regulatory unpredictability is now a proven risk to the platform. [8-K FY25]

3. Legal Costs and Dilution: A $950M Arbutus/ Genevant litigation payment hit cash in July 2026, with ongoing royalties inflating cost of sales. The September $2.6B convertible adds 12.3M potential shares of dilution. [10-Q Q2 26]

Forward Growth Drivers

- Intismeran personalized cancer vaccine with Merck; Phase III melanoma interim in H2 2026 [8-K guid]
- Respiratory portfolio expansion: mNEXSPIKE rollout, FDA-approved flu vaccine, EU market opening 2027 [8-K guid]
- Cost discipline: 2025 operating expenses cut $2.2B (30%), 2026 GAAP opex guided to ~$4.7B ex litigation [8-K guid]

Missing / Modified Data Log

- Gross margin by product line not disclosed; cost of sales reported consolidated.
- Peer forward multiples (BNTX, NVAX) not verified from a current source; scored qualitatively.
- FY2022-24 cash balances and net loss figures not independently verified; revenue history verified via WallStreetZen annuals.

This scorecard is for educational and informational purposes only. It is not financial, investment, or tax advice, and nothing here is a recommendation to buy or sell any security. It is generated by an AI model and does not consider your individual circumstances. All figures are approximate, may be out of date, and are not guaranteed to be accurate. Verify independently and consult a licensed professional before investing. You are responsible for your own investment decisions.

Not financial advice. For educational purposes only. Do your own research.